



INTRODUCTION TO YOGA

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❖ **INTRODUCTION OF YOGA**

- Yoga is the only science which takes care of the all-round development of three essential elements- body, mind and soul together.
- Yogic Practice is a holistic science which includes the culture of the body , the mind as well as the spirit.
- The word 'Yoga' is a Sanskrit word which originated from the root 'YUJ'.
- The meaning of 'yuj' is 'to join', 'to unite' 'to yoke'. As such, yoga means 'to unite together', to act in unison with mutual understanding, co-operation, co-ordination, love and affection, avoiding all differences, conflicts, ill-will and hatred, with one mind, one thought, to arrive at the one and same goal.

❖ **OBJECTIVES OF YOGA**

- a) To bring peace and tranquility of mind, freeing it from all stress and strains, worries and anxieties.
- b) To bring balance and harmony in the body-mind-soul complex.
- c) To explore and unfold the latent talents, by controlling nature both external and internal, annihilating the evils within.
- d) To gain sound health.
- e) To train the body and mind in a way to avoid rigidity and bring flexibility.
- f) To develop immunity and resistance power.
- g) To master the secrets of doing work efficiently and excel in tasks taken up; in the social complex, as well as, the global complex.
- h) To keep the internal body clean and detoxified and thereby render it free from disease.
- i) To transform a mundane life to a blissful godly life.

RELEVANCE OF YOGA IN MODERN AGE

- Yoga is relevant in modern life because it can help with many aspects of health and well – being such as ,
- Yoga can improve strength , balance and flexibility. It can also help with back pain and arthritis.
- Yoga can help you fall asleep
- Yoga can help you connect with a supportive community.
- Yoga can help improve your emotional stability.
- Yoga can help improve mental clarity, concentration, and reduce stress.
- Yoga can help you feel more energetic and alert
- Yoga can also help to reduce your blood pressure , and heart rate.
- Yoga can also help you purify your internal organs and systems, as well as thoughts and feelings.
- The benefits of yoga have gained greater awareness today. More people are practicing yoga as a way to achieve physical, mental, and emotional wellbeing.



INTRODUCTION TO HATHA YOGA

The word 'hatha' can be translated two ways : as ' willful' or 'forceful', or the yoga of activity , and as 'sun' 'ha' and 'moon' (tha), the yoga of balance. Essentially , Hatha Yoga practices are design to align and calm your body, mind, and spirit in preparation for meditation. Most forms of yoga in the West can be classified as Hatha Yoga. Hatha simply refers to the practice of physical yoga postures.

Hatha yoga is a branch of yoga that combines physical practices with breathing techniques and other practices to improve the body & mind. Hatha yoga involves physical postures , called **asanas**, that are held for several breaths. Hatha yoga emphasizes controlled breathing , called **pranayama**.

RAJA YOGA

- Raja Yoga is the **royal path** of yoga. As a king maintains control over his kingdom from his capital, so also, in Raja Yoga, the Yogi maintains control over the kingdom of his mind through psychological control. **Raja Yoga is also called classical yoga.** The term 'Raja yoga' was used in Sanskrit texts to refer to both the goal of yoga and the method to attain it. In the 19th century, Swami Vivekananda gave his interpretation of the Yoga Sutras of Patanjali in his book Raja yoga, which popularized the term as a modern name for the practice of yoga.

Benefits of 'Raja Yoga' meditation

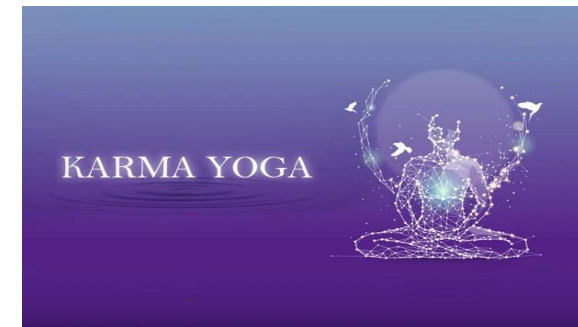
- Improved mental clarity and focus.
- Reduced stress and increased relaxation
- Improved relationship and communication skills
- Increased resilience and ability to cope with challenges.

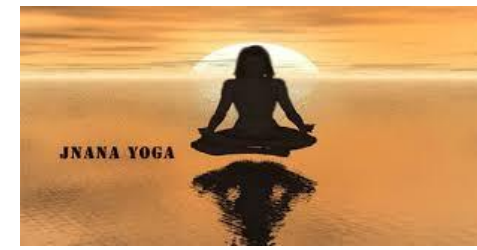
KARMA YOGA

- Karma Yoga is selfless devotion to work for **social wellbeing**. A Karma Yogi sees God in all beings and for him service to beings becomes service to God. To such an individual, work is worship. He **works with dedication** for the welfare and happiness of others, sacrificing his selfish interest, his ego, happiness and sorrow.

The basic principles of Karma Yoga are –

1. Right attitude while doing work.
2. Right motive- love to serve without any profit-motive, to get reward, remuneration, name and fame.
3. Contribute the utmost by doing one's work with heart and soul.
4. Give up the thought of success and failure from mind.
5. Follow the discipline of the work.
6. Treat any work as service to God.





GYANA YOGA

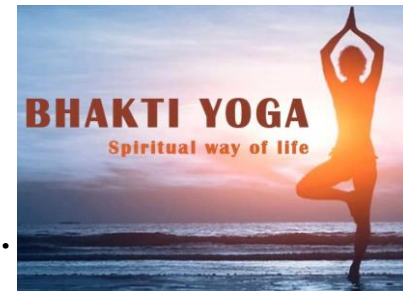
- Defined as the practice of shedding the ego and gaining knowledge of the true self through self study and analysis. With this deep awareness of the 'Self', you are able to understand the difference between what is real and unreal.
- The methods of Jnana Yoga are – first Listening/Studying (Sravana/Adhyana), then thinking and analyzing (Manan/Vislekhan) and at last diving deep into it and realising the truth (Anudhyasan).

Gyana yoga has 4 principles :

- 1) Viveka : Discrimination
- 2) Vairagya – Renunciation (liberate oneself inwardly from any desire for earthly pleasure or possessions).
- 3) Shatsampatti – The Six Treasurers (Shama (calmness of mind), Dama(self – control), Uparati(withdrawal from sensory distractions), Titiksha(endurance), Shradda(faith in spiritual path), Samadhana (focus or concentration)).
- 4) Mumukshutva – Constant Striving for God (burning desire in the heart to realize God and unite with God).

BHAKTI YOGA

- Bhakti Yoga is the yoga of devotion to God in some form or the other.
- A Bhakta Yogi **surrenders completely to God**, the Almighty. Love is the core element of Bhakti Yoga.
- Nine kinds of Bhakti or devotion are mentioned in 'Narada Bhakti Sutra', 'Srimad Bhagawata' etc.
- These are- **Shravana** (Listening to chanting in praise of the Deity), **Kirtana** (Singing religious songs), **Smarana** (Remembering the Deity), **Pada-Sevana** (serving at the feet of the Deity), **Archana** (worshipping), **Bandana** (Praising), **Dasya** (acting like a slave), **Sakhya** (treating the Deity as friend) and **Atma- Nivedana** (Self surrendering).



UNDERSTANDING EIGHT STEPS OF ASHTANGA YOGA

- In Patanjali's Yoga Sutra, the eightfold path is called ashtanga, which literally means “eight limbs”. These eight steps basically act as guidelines on how to live a meaningful and purposeful life. They serve as a prescription for moral and ethical conduct and self-discipline; they direct attention toward one's health; and they help us to acknowledge the spiritual aspects of our nature. In brief the eight limbs, or steps to yoga, are as follows: 1) Yama 2) Niyama 3) Asanas 4) Pranayama 5) Pratyahara 6) Dharana 7) Dhyana 8) Samadhi.

1) YAMA (PRINCIPLE OF MORAL CODE)

- Ahimsa – A principle of non-violence
- Satya – A principle of Truthfulness
- Asteya – A principle of non stealing
- Brahmacharya – Continence / celibacy
- Aparigraha – A principle of non – hoarding or non possessiveness.

2) NIYAMA (PERSONAL DISCIPLINES)

- Shoucha – Purity
- Santosh – Contentment
- Tapa – Endurance
- Swadhyaya – Self study
- Eshwar Pranidhan – Dedication

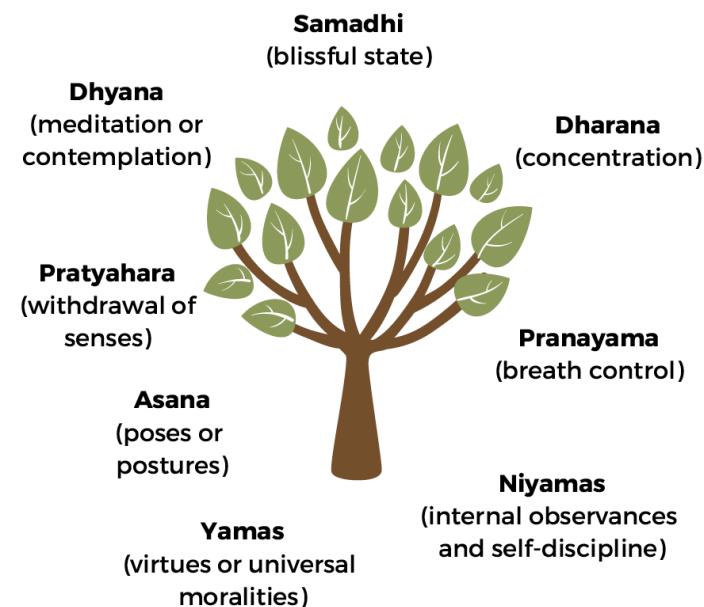
3) ASANA (YOGA POSITIONS OR YOGIC POSTURES)

4) PRANAYAMA (YOGIC BREATHING)

5) PRATYAHARA (WITHDRAWAL OF SENSES)

A mental preparation to increase the power of mind.

The Eight Limbs of Ashtanga



6) **DHARANA (CONCENTRATION ON OBJECT)**

7) **DHYAN (MEDITATION)**

8) **SAMADHI (SALVATION)** : state of super bliss, joy and merging individual consciousness in to universal consciousness.

